TOCHUKWU CYPRIAN OKPARA

Senior Software Engineer | Fullstack Engineering | Technical Leadership

Ontario, Canada | okpara_tochukwu@yahoo.com

Portfolio | GitHub | LinkedIn

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer and technical lead experienced in designing and maintaining production applications using Node.js, TypeScript, Python, Django, NestJS, React, and Next.js. Lead team of engineers developing a CRM platform. Experienced in distributed services, REST APIs, event-driven architecture, PostgreSQL, Redis, cloud infrastructure, CI/CD, performance optimization, and production reliability. MSc in Computer Science.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Backend: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Ruby, Node.js, NestJS, Express.js, Django, Ruby on Rails
Frontend: React, Next.js, Redux, HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS
Data & Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, GCP, AWS (EC2, S3, IAM), Docker, Kubernetes
Engineering & Operations: REST APIs, event-driven architecture, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Git, Sentry, Monit, PM2, code reviews, TDD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Engineer | FirstActive365, Birmingham, UK | Oct 2024 – Present

- Lead team of software engineers across architecture, sprint planning, code reviews, hiring, and delivery of a CRM platform serving approximately 20,000 active users.
- Architect and maintain Node.js, Django, and Next.js services connected through REST APIs and event-driven architecture, using PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, and GCP.
- Optimized backend queries and introduced Redis caching, reducing shift and client-list response times from approximately 60 seconds to less than 100 milliseconds.
- Led transition from outsourced to in-house engineering through knowledge transfer, legacy issue resolution, documentation, and system upgrades.
- Delivered recurring shift functionality and streamlined shift creation from approximately five minutes to under one minute; improved compliance review and bulk-approval workflows.
- Introduced GitHub Actions CI/CD and lint checks; improved observability with Sentry, Monit, and PM2 process management.

Senior Fullstack Developer | Media Beast, Birmingham, UK | Apr 2024 – Aug 2024

- Took technical ownership of CRM development, making architecture decisions and implementing backend and frontend functionality.
- Designed and implemented a client pipeline feature spanning backend architecture and frontend interfaces.
- Integrated the Care Quality Commission (CQC) API to support access to external regulatory information.
- Implemented retry mechanisms and error handling for compliance document uploads to address document-loss issues and improve reliability.
- Collaborated with engineers and UI/UX designers to deliver CRM features.

Software Development Demonstrator | Birmingham City University, Birmingham, UK | Sep 2023 – Apr 2024

- Led practical software development sessions for approximately 150 master's students, mentoring React, Express.js, and MongoDB projects.
- Debugged student applications, reviewed implementations, and guided collaborative software development and code quality practices.

Fullstack Developer | JOBEX, Remote | Apr 2022 – Jan 2023

- Designed and built recruitment-platform dashboards and job-listing interfaces using Next.js and React.
- Refactored frontend functionality to improve developer experience and accelerate feature development.
- Enhanced Ruby on Rails backend features and collaborated with senior engineers on reviews and implementation.

Technical Support Engineer (Code Reviewer) | Microverse, Remote | Mar 2022 – Dec 2022

- Reviewed 60+ fullstack projects monthly, providing technical feedback on coding standards, defects, and maintainability.
- Mentored developers through code reviews and actionable recommendations.

EDUCATION

MSc, Computer Science | Birmingham City University, UK | 2023–2024

BSc, Mechanical Engineering | University of Ibadan, Nigeria | 2013–2018

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Cloud Development Nanodegree — ALX-T / Udacity (2022) | Full Stack Web Development — Microverse (2021–2022)